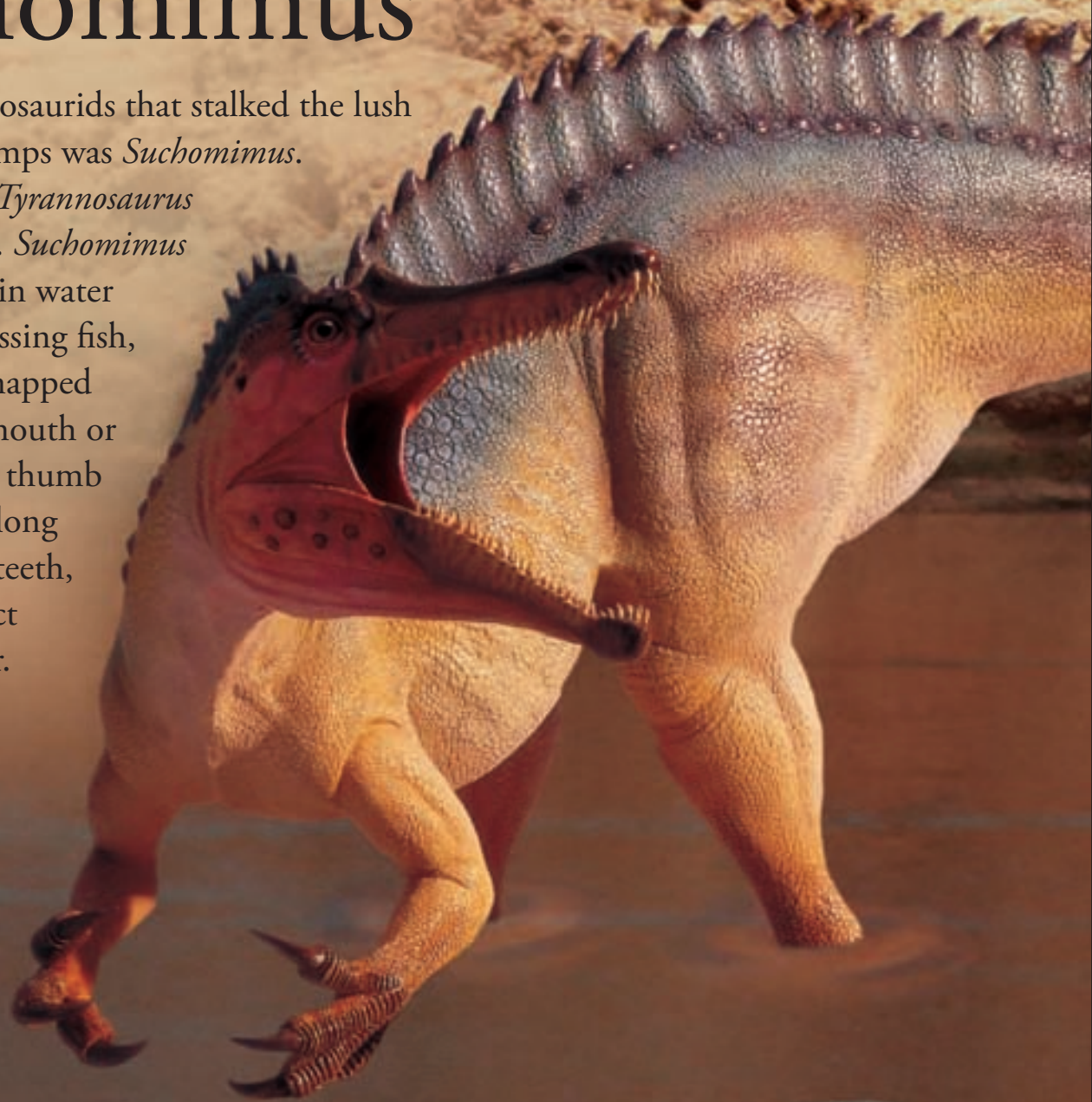


Suchomimus

One of the spinosaurids that stalked the lush Cretaceous swamps was *Suchomimus*.

It was as big as *Tyrannosaurus* but hunted fish. *Suchomimus* probably stood in water watching for passing fish, which it then snapped up in its huge mouth or speared with its thumb claws. With its long jaws and sharp teeth, it was the perfect swamp predator.

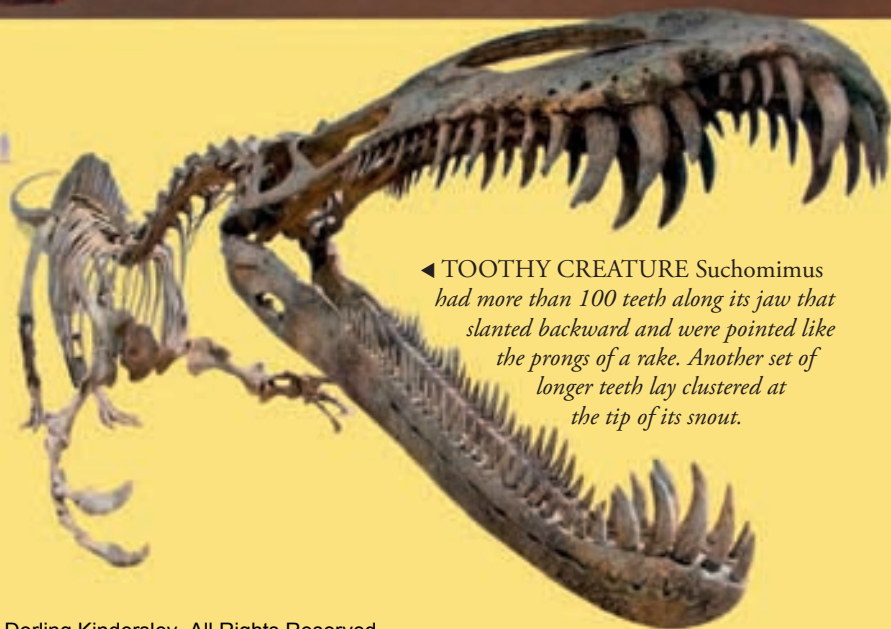


Suchomimus

soo-ko-MIME-us

- **When** 112 million years ago (Early Cretaceous)
- **Fossil location** Africa
- **Habitat** Mangrove swamps
- **Length** 30 ft (9 m)
- **Diet** Fish, possibly meat

Suchomimus, meaning “crocodile mimic,” got its name from its crocodile-like snout and sharp teeth, which it used to catch fish and other slippery prey. Compared to other meat eaters, it had long and powerful arms—perhaps it used them to reach into the water to grasp prey. A bladelike sail ran along its back and perhaps its tail.



◀ **TOOTHY CREATURE** *Suchomimus* had more than 100 teeth along its jaw that slanted backward and were pointed like the prongs of a rake. Another set of longer teeth lay clustered at the tip of its snout.